RAFAEL TADESSE

Full-Stack Software Engineer | Product Builder | Startup Founder

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SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer and founder who builds products from idea to launch. Experienced with TypeScript, React, Nodejs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Supabase, and Docker, with hands-on ownership across product development, deployment, infrastructure, and user feedback. Built and launched 4+ independent products, including one that reached 7,000 users on an infrastructure budget under $10/month. Brings a product mindset, fast execution, and comfort learning what a problem requires.

EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer

Wealth Circles 02/2026 - Present Oakland, California - Remote

- Owned the end-to-end development of a production-ready investment-community MVP, shipping in just 15 days ahead of the client's YC application.
- Built core product features using React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, and Supabase, including invite-only investment circles, watchlists, and financial goals.
- Managed the product lifecycle from implementation and deployment to gathering user feedback and iterating on features.
- Contributed to early user acquisition by supporting product outreach, engaging prospective users, and using feedback to guide product improvements.

Software Engineer

Shir Shir Business Group 02/2024 - 11/2025 Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Designed, developed, and maintained the company’s core software infrastructure, including its delivery service, coffee service, and portfolio management platform.
- Built the end-to-end infrastructure for referral services, integrating referral workflows and payment management into the platform.
- Developed and maintained backend services and APIs to support business operations, service delivery, and payment processing.
- Developed and deployed microservices architecture, resulting in improved system reliability by 35%.
- Provided technical guidance during architectural changes which resulted in a 15% increase in deployment efficiency.

Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

HashTag Technology 06/2021 - 12/2023 Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Led the development of IT management software used by government offices in Addis Ababa, overseeing the platform’s architecture, implementation, and ongoing maintenance.
- Designed and managed the platform’s infrastructure, focusing on system security, reliability, and performance under heavy public usage.
- Oversaw backend development, database management, and system optimization to support reliable access and efficient information management.
- Coordinated technical decisions and development priorities to ensure the platform met operational requirements and could support government office workflows at scale.

EDUCATION

Computer Science - Undergraduate Studies

Addis Ababa University

01/2018 - 01/2020 Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

LANGUAGES

English Proficient ●●●●○ French Beginner ●○○○○

PROJECTS

Orcha

AI-powered Zoom meeting assistant for focused, productive meetings.

Lumi

Developer monetization platform with integrated payments and custom domains.

Interestly

Social platform connecting people through shared interests.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

End-to-End Product Development

Independently built and launched 4+ products, owning the entire lifecycle from technical architecture and development to deployment and user acquisition.

Scalable Product Growth

Grew a product to over 7,000 users while maintaining infrastructure costs below $10/month through cost-efficient architecture and infrastructure decisions.